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The Dreaded Debt Collector

Debt collectors exist in Canada too of course. Canadian law has the Collection Agencies Act, which states what debt collectors can and cannot do. They are not supposed to contact you on a holiday or a Sunday, except between 1 and 5 pm. They are not supposed to contact you other than by ordinary mail more than three times in a seven day period. Some things never change, no matter what country we are talking about. The most complaints received by the Ontario Ministry of Government and Consumer Affairs have to do with collection agencies. If you need more information, contact the Consumer Protection Branch at 1-800-889-9768.

If you have issues specific to your province or a consumer affairs question, the contact information is provided here for you.

Directory of Organizations – Consumer Affairs Offices

Staff in these offices can help you with consumer problems.

Federal Government

Office of Consumer Affairs

Industry Canada

235 Queen Street

Ottawa ON K1A 0H5

Fax: (613) 952-6927

Email: consumer.information@ic.gc.ca

Website: www.consumer.ic.gc.ca

Competition Bureau

50 Victoria Street

Gatineau QC K1A 0C9

Tel.: (819) 997-4282

Toll Free: 1-800-348-5358

TDD: 1-800-642-3844

Fax: (819) 997-0324

Email: compbureau@cb-bc.gc.ca

Website: www.competitionbureau.gc.ca